

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

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find me and SNZ at the zine fest this year! - plebpoet





off the web
and into your hands:

STACKER NEWS ZINE

Note from the Editor

Are we out of the zap wars yet? I couldn't say with any certainty, but most definitely probably not. And that's okay because money is doing its moderating job and we all got rewarded for it!

A few comments in here will mention a post that I chose not to include. Although it was the top post, I have an editor's right to make a worthwhile zine.

ZAP!



Should we want to grow Stacker News? If so, how?



23.5k sats \ 52 comments \

@magnolia_mayhem 6 Sep AskSN lightning

I admit that I have issues with insecurity. I'm constantly afraid that things that I like will go away, and that is a fear has been re-enforced over the years with the great things that we've all lost. This anxiety applies to Stacker News as well and I've had the lifelong conviction that if you aren't growing, you're dying; a quote that I heard my dad shout from a pulpit of our church when I was twelve or thirteen. I still hear that line in the back of my head when I look at communitites that I've become a part of.

I like SN. It's one of the few places on the internet that has a good incentive structure and on top of that, an incentive structure that ties into bitcoin. I haven't been here long and I'm also pretty late to the party so my long-term experience isn't really there. I'm sure that there's a lot that I've missed because of that. Regardless, I feel a connection to this place and want it to succeed.

A part of that desire to see this place succeed is growth. If I could, I would want to see a million people here, zapping around and arguing but that isn't necessarily a good thing. Places lose part of what made them great when huge crowds show up. Generally speaking, the more people who show up, the lower the average quality. That million people might just be the worst thing that could happen here compared to a tiny trickle of new users or even losing users. I can understand why someone would want this place to stay small.

Would that happen here? Would seeing huge growth across Stacker News ruin it? If not, how do we grow? If the path ahead for this place is growth, how do we ensure the people that we draw here are the kind of people we would want to bring in? I know this is a bit odd for someone who hasn't managed to be here for a full year, but this really does bother me.

comments

comments

441 sats \ 0 replies \ **@Undisciplined** 6 Sep

Everyone who loves SN seems to ponder this question.

My feeling now is that we don't need to grow into a huge platform (say millions of stackers). If we could just manage to double, while roughly maintaining our quality and culture, that would be huge. Even better if that growth largely comes from some of the early stackers returning.

96 sats \ 0 replies \ **@MAKESONGSLONGER** 7 Sep

I enjoy SN. It's worth keeping / growing. Slow and steady though. No need to grow crazy. I feel like it's nice to have a little bitcoiner community rather than traipse into the waters of reddit. I hate reddit.

Shitcoin/scam ads on SN - yay or nay, and why?

7955 sats \ 76 comments \ **@optimism** 6 Sep
meta AskSN



I just spent some time with @siggy47 in yesterday's saloon arguing about moral aspects around shitcoin posts on SN and the boosts that (in my opinion) make them into ads. I have a pretty strong opinion on this but since the intensity of my feelings don't make me right, I wonder what stackers think.

Premise

The premise I'd pose is that boosts are paid advertising, very similar to how you'd pay FB or TikTok to make your post/video appear in more feeds, except on SN, you don't pay SN. Instead, you pay:

1. The territory owner(s) for 70% of the boost, and
2. Reward-eligible stackers for 30% of the boost

So basically, territory owners and stackers that get a piece of the daily rewards are getting paid for each boost. A boost that sits unchallenged is therefore an accepted advertisement: "We accept your sats, have your stage".

Consequence for boosted shitcoin and scam posts

As long as my premise holds, when a shitcoiner posts a story about their new thing, or a scammer posts a new product that rugs its users, and boosts it, it too is an ad. Sold to the scammer/shitcoiner by the people that received the boost sats, and therefore, these stackers profit from the scam/shitcoin.

If a territory owner disagrees with the scam being promoted on their territory, then they can, at no additional cost, downzap the post for that 70%. These sats will then go 100% to rewards, making the remainder of undoing the boost, if they feel so inclined, sit in the hands of the stackers that will receive the payout. At this point, 100% of the boost will be paid out to stackers in the next rewards payout, and the scammer can be 100% neutralized, only if 30% of the stackers are in agreement that the scam should not be promoted. So stackers as a whole have the upper hand here.

Now of course, this means that you say good-bye to a portion of those nice little sats that you just got magically paid out to you for not doing anything other than zap here and there (hard work, I know.)

Questions to the stackers

Is it okay to profit from scammers? Would you use your "hard-earned" reward sats to reduce the visibility of scams? Or is opti being a delusional idealist? Or even an evil aspiring dictator?

I hope we can talk about this.

570 sats \ 21 replies \ **@Undisciplined** 6 Sep
Delusional idealism is an important part of what we're trying to do here.

It seems important to note that not all of us are equally equipped to assess scams, nor do we have an obligation to patrol content we wouldn't otherwise be interested in for the purpose of searching out scams.

So, I'd say it almost has to be ok to profit from people promoting their scams on SN (which is different from actually profiting off the scam).

I do agree with you about territory owners. We probably should try to neutralize scams when we see them posted in our territories. It's not exactly the same as an endorsement, but we are taking payment for visibility, even if it's a permissionless process.

339 sats \ 6 replies \ **@grayruby** 6 Sep

I don't think it is much of an issue currently.

If shitcoiners want to pay to promote their garbage to deaf ears or pay to get ridiculed. Let them.

That being said obviously there is a point where too much of this crap could corrode the SN experience but I don't think we are at that point and I don't think there is much value for shitcoiners to post there crap here because they aren't going to convince anyone.

I ended up muting the guy yesterday because he wasn't debating in good faith but I don't care that he posted.

313 sats \ 6 replies \ **@siggy47** 6 Sep

As I argued earlier, I don't like downzapping as a solution. I'm not certain it's even effective. The "Streisand effect" may give a post even more attention than ignoring it or vigorously engaging the OP in a debate. Also, censorship isn't really possible when well funded whales on both sides have a tit for tat, as we have seen.

I agree it is a problem. I don't see a solution, except by ending this whole boosting craze completely. Let's go back to straight posting. Posts will get attention based on merit.

↳ 47 sats \ 5 replies \ **@optimism** OP 6 Sep

FWIW, I don't like downzapping as a solution either. At least not in the downzap war style with tons of sats wasted. In small amounts, i.e. giving your opinion with your standard zap up or down and done, I don't mind it so much. The wars are the painful thing.

255 sats \ 1 reply \ **@OT** 6 Sep

It's still a new thing for me and I haven't really taken a solid position at the moment.

It does make it interesting when a sh\$tcoiner comes in with a bag of sats likely exchanged from their printed sh\$tcoin. I think the downzappers are legends for distributing sats to the community.

The one yesterday surprised me as I thought that they'd boosted the post too high that no amount of downzapping could counter. But it did!

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How do rewards actually work!?

3466 sats \ 77 comments \ **@flat24** 7 Sep AskSN



Could someone please explain to me how this works on SN?

Yesterday, I was sending out "zaps."

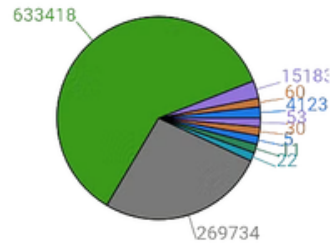
According to the spenders' list, I ranked 13th, and then today...

2		@k00b	302.5k spent \ 191.8k stacked \ 4 items
3		@Scoresby	26.3k spent \ 226.7k stacked \ 50 items
4		stacker is in hiding	
5		@BlockchainB	11.6k spent \ 30.4k stacked \ 39 items
6		@Kruw	10.1k spent \ 4808 stacked \ 1 item
7		@guerratotal	9236 spent \ 107.9k stacked \ 14 items
8		@Undisciplined	7720 spent \ 32.8k stacked \ 47 items
9		stacker is in hiding	
10		@0xbitcoiner	4632 spent \ 73.9k stacked \ 28 items
11		@openbitcoin	4600 spent \ 49 stacked \ 0 items
12		stacker is in hiding	
13		@flat24	4150 spent \ 3610 stacked \ 6 items

only visible to you

On 2026-09-07 at 12a CT

922641 sats were rewarded



you earned 222 sats (0.02%)

👉 #48 in post zapping for 222 sats

I received this notification.

How is it possible that spending 4,000 sats—and supposedly ranking 13th on the spenders' list—only nets me 222 sats from a 900,000-sat pot?

Honestly, I don't get it at all.

That's why I'm asking: how do rewards actually work?

Is it handled only by a select group?

Is it part of a premium membership I don't know about?

Or do only friends of the developer running the platform have access to the rewards and the information?

How does this really work?

comments comments

265 sats \ 4 replies \ **@Scoresby** 7 Sep

Several years ago, Stacker News did an experiment called Million Sat Madness where the rewards were piled up for a whole month and then disbursed to stackers based on their ranking for the whole month.

I got pretty interested in competing and really tried to win. Notably, I spent no effort looking at SN's code to see how rankings were calculated nor did I really bother myself with reading very many of the posts about it. I think this was before the widespread availability of LLMs. I certainly wasn't using one at that point to tell me the optimal strategy.

I mostly tried to write really cool posts and zap stuff that others would like early. I completely overlooked zapping comments/replies.

Needless to say, I did not rank as highly as I hoped. And I felt pretty frustrated by that experience. It felt like there was a group of insiders who knew how things worked and were able to get ahead through some arcane means that I didn't understand.

Since then, I've continued to use SN, and if I can distill what I've learned about getting rewards on SN it is this:

- hang out on [stacker.news/new](#)
- when you see good, interesting, original posts zap them (usually at least 1000 sats)
- post about some interesting topic that you can "cover" (helps if it is Bitcoin related)
- when people reply to you, zap them at least 100 sats
- when you are reading a particularly interesting thread, zap everyone who comments (except the bots)

This isn't exactly what the code rewards, but it's close enough that it makes sense to my brain.

If you really want to figure it out, point your favorite LLM at Stacker News's github and ask it to tell you how to optimize winning daily rewards.

346 sats \ 11 replies \ **@grayruby** 7 Sep

Spending the most doesn't guarantee you the most returns. You have to zap popular content and early.

1112 sats \ 18 replies \ **@nullcount** 7 Sep

SN is open source: <https://github.com/stackernews/stacker.news>

learn the rules, play the game, be selfish, if you invest well, you can earn dozens of sats per day

jk, just get a real job and stop playing silly games with internet strangers

112 sats \ 2 replies \ **@Coinsreporter** 7 Sep

Zap early, zap big.

This is what you missed.



Meme Monday

227 sats \ 5 comments \ @sn 7 Sep memes



21 sats \ 0 replies \ @0xbitcoiner 7 Sep



**JOIN THE
CONVERSATION
ON STACKER.NEWS
AND TUNE INTO
STACKER NEWS LIVE
EVERY FRIDAY**

before and after



cocaine

alcohol



crack

 **Stacker News** 

246 sats \ 6 replies \ @0xbitcoiner 11 Sep

Little Victoria



7111 sats \ 28 comments \ [@jasonb](#)
10 Sep gaming Education history

TLDR: Check out my new game! (for desktop, not mobile)



Little Victoria

My ten year old asked me to make her a game in which she builds a city. In trying to do so, I found this really cool website that had a set of open source Victorian buildings for making games. I can only assume that the artists (Liberated Pixel Cup) were intending these to be for murder mysteries or something like that.

Nevertheless, I decided to turn it into a city builder with some sneaky educational elements. I got so excited that I bought a domain^[1] and started working on more sneaky educational games using all this cool open source game art. While it's geared towards a ten year old girl, I find it pretty fun too, so I'm sharing with you.



Here are a couple postcards from the city I'm building:



Greetings from Vaderville!

September 1859 - 322 townsfolk - Lady Mayor's own collection



Greetings from Vaderville!

September 1862 - 432 townsfolk - Lady Mayor's own collection

Here's the link to play: [Little Victoria](#)

Heavy zaps for anybody that can find historical inaccuracies or anachronisms that I need to fix.^[2] I'm going to keep adding features too, so let me know if you've got any suggestions. Anywho, enjoy!

1. Yeah, the hub website is currently sloppy. The games are not though! I've actually put a ton of time into making sure it's as accurate as possible and really fun to play. [🔗](#)
2. Real problems, not stupid things like, "that particular building doesn't look right." I'm looking for issues that are clearly teaching something important in which I really got part of the info wrong. Finding typos would be helpful too though. [🔗](#)

Slowly Exiting the Fiat World with Bitcoin e-SIM



10.2k sats \ 37 comments \ @Natalia 10 Sep bitcoin

Recently, I noticed my current SIM card subscription is about to expire, so I checked how much the new subscription will cost. The SIM provider has jacked up the price over the years in the name of giving you MORE internet data, which I barely use. I don't really need 50 GB each month or 2000 mins for calls. *It's really important to know what you actually need, because the fiat world loves to package things you don't need.* So I was thinking maybe switch to prepaid, pay-as-I-go, and I had to call the call center *three* times to get it done. **Only after going through things like this do you really appreciate how much better the experience is with Bitcoin e-SIM services.**

I would like to share the current Bitcoin e-SIM options (mainly for internet and receiving messages) and my experience here.



Silent link

No KYC, no email needed. I have been using Silent Link for at least two years, and I've traveled to different countries with it. You are literally able to access the local internet the second you land, which is really handy for travelers!

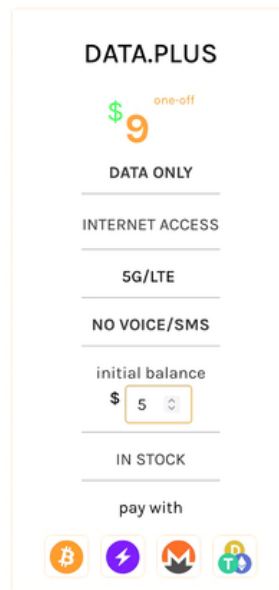
Another bonus: even in places where one local provider is weak, you can manually switch to another, which basically means you can choose the provider whenever instead of locking into one like in the fiat world.

Pricing: \$9 for data only, with a \$5 initial balance.

The paying experience is great. Onchain and LN payment available. It redirects to a unique link with a QR code after you pay, then you just scan it with your phone, super easy. Don't forget to bookmark the unique link for later top-ups. Top-up is super simple too: just go back to the unique link you bookmarked, create an invoice, and pay.

To check how much money is left, dial *187#.

Silent Link also offers number rental (US numbers only). I tried that too, but the number I got couldn't register for some apps, so I stopped using it.



Nadanada

No KYC, no email needed. Nadanada has more services than Silent Link, including VPN, e-SIM, disposable numbers, and number rental; I tested the 3-month rental number, and I quite liked the overall experience, especially the part that you don't need to download another App so to receive messages, all you need is simply log back in to the link, which is super cool!

Pricing

3-month UK rental number: \$12; 12-month UK rental number: \$44.

It also redirects to a unique link after payment, don't forget to bookmark it for renew or to receive messages.

I think Nadanada is especially good for business. Don't use Google Voice or anything like that, because they would take the number back for no reason. One more detail to share is that **you need to verify the rental number's cleanliness before renting it long-term.** For example, I got two numbers from Nadanada; one can register for most apps I tested, but the other had trouble with one app.

Another issue I've found so far is that **once the rental period expires, you can't renew the same number anymore, and all your message history is gone too**, which isn't good if you want to use it for something important. You can definitely rent it for one year or longer and even set a remind email, but do keep that in mind.

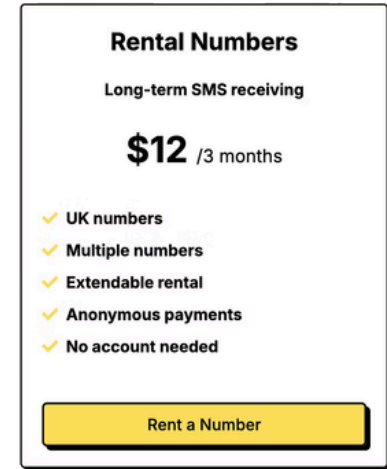
I have a suggestion: *how about giving people a grace period to renew the same number after it expires? Maybe even an option to download the message history.* @nadanada_me

The Art of Slowly Exiting the Fiat World

I'm aware that a local SIM is necessary for local delivery and any Gov-related things, but it's better to limit its use; for example, avoid using it to register any of your online profiles.

My current setup is a prepaid local SIM, Silent Link for internet, and Nadanada for sites that need a verification code. The best part about these Bitcoin e-SIMs is that you pay for what you actually use, and even better: **you might develop a better habit of using your phone less when you're out!**

Less screen time, less internet use, spend less money (save more sats), and spend more time in real life with people around you, which sounds quite a good deal! I've started taking a notebook with me now. Since I am learning a new language, I can spend more time learning instead of checking what's going on on the internet.



Disclosures

I won't get paid or anything for recommending them, I just enjoy finding tools that make my life easier, and happy to share my experience. After you try how things work with Bitcoin, you simply CAN'T go back to fiat companies. Since a few people have asked previously, "Will you use Bitcoin as your everyday money?" It actually starts with small things like this.

Once you taste the simplicity and peace of mind compared with fiat companies, you will slowly try to find alternatives to exit the fiat world. Even better, you learn how to create it yourself if you can't find it.

Enjoy! ⚡

STACKER NEWS STACKER NEWS

comments comments comments

122 sats \ 2 replies \ @Scoresby 10 Sep

I haven't given up my carrier phone number yet (my US number is tied to a lot of stuff in life, it feels very complicated to make sure I change all of it).

But I have used silent link a fair bit when travelling. It's pretty great! I love that feeling of landing somewhere and switching to my esim and poof! I'm on the internet. I've found silent link to be pretty affordable in most of the places I've been. But I may be like you, someone who doesn't use a huge amount of data (no streaming, no games, so on).

Great article, though! This is the kind of stuff I love hearing about.

172 sats \ 1 reply \ @LightOfBitcoin 10 Sep

Yeah, I've been thinking about trying an eSIM like this for travel. Paying with Bitcoin and getting online right after landing is pretty damn convenient.

127 sats \ 2 replies \ @optimism 10 Sep

< "After you try how things work with Bitcoin, you simply CAN'T go back to fiat companies."

Seconded. I can't imagine dealing with all the admin crap needed for a normie e-sim. I'd be really sad if I were forced to.

< "It actually starts with small things like this."

Exactly. Comms were the first thing I was able to fully orchestrate through LN and never look back. It's also great that there are multiple providers for this.

Can men and women be friends?



8250 sats \ 61 comments \ @bief57
11 Sep AskSN relationships

I ask this trivial question because, although many people talk about it, an objective answer is never reached. My father, the king of womanizers, taught my sister and me that friendship between men and women doesn't exist, because "men will always want to have sex with you," and things like that. Over time, life experiences have led me to believe that statement is true.

Unlike me, my sister actually believes in friendship between men and women; one of her best friends is a man well, that's a bit of a long story, but I won't get into it. My dad always teases her about it, basically telling her that the guy isn't really her friend and that if the chance to get intimate with her ever arose, he wouldn't pass it up. Whenever he can, or whenever he sees a video on social media about male-female friendship that supports his view, he sends it to us. Today, he sent a video like that to a family group chat that includes my dad's daughters, my daughter, and him. The video doesn't contain anything obscene or explicit; it simply reinforces the point I've been making here.

My daughter, in her innocence, replied:

"I've ended up hanging out with more boys than girls at school; in fact, my best friend is a boy."

611 sats \ 6 replies \ @k00b 11 Sep

I think so. I also think the underlying desire for intimacy can go both ways, although it's more rare in the other direction, because it requires a man to have relatively high sexual worth.

I generally like female friends because the dynamic is familiar - my household had only women in it. On average, most men lack emotional depth, and the ones with fragile egos tend to jockey for position in local hierarchies and are disappointed in me not wanting to participate, which I find annoying. Also, most men don't like it when I tease them which tends to be one of my favorite things to do to people. Women also tend to be way better listeners and more malleable, so it's easier to sync with them rather than letting a dude talk at me nonstop.

To the question, I'd only call a female friend a friend if I wouldn't be intimate with her in whatever context we are friends in - regardless of how desirable I found them to be - and I think that liking the way your friend looks is a bonus if anything. That kind of nuance is lost and probably not available to people without self control though. That said, there's also a large population of people that are cheats and sneaks inherently, so it's best to at least consider the worst occasionally when evaluating male-female relationships.

319 sats \ 10 replies \ @Undisciplined 11 Sep

Sounds like somebody needs a reminder: if a beautiful woman wants to talk to you about bitcoin, you should mute him.

audio

comments comments